

This Week in Maintenance, Repair & Overhaul

Week covered · 26 Aug – 2 Sep 2026
Posted · 2 September 2026
For · Staff, faculty & students

Three stories from the past seven days, chosen because they connect to what is taught in this building: the parts supply chain, structural inspection, and the licence that lets you sign for the work.

01 INDUSTRY & SUPPLY CHAIN

Retired A320s Are Being Turned Into Spare Parts

The aftermarket for used Airbus A320 parts is running hot. On 27 August, parts supplier Werner Aero confirmed its second A320-200 purchase of the month — aircraft MSN 2964 — which goes to the eCube facility at St Athan in Wales to be dismantled. Aviation Week's daily MRO log recorded further teardown deals in the same week, including a HEICO subsidiary, Prime Air, taking an ex-Spirit Airlines A320neo to Arizona for component disassembly.

When an aircraft is retired, usable components — landing gear, avionics boxes, actuators, cabin items — are removed, inspected, repaired and re-certified. They then re-enter service as **USM: used serviceable material**. USM is legal, traceable, and often the fastest route to a part when new production has long lead times.

Note how young some of these airframes are. Neo-generation aircraft being torn down this early tells you how tight the parts market has become.

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A320-200 airframes bought by Werner Aero for teardown in August alone

WHY IT MATTERS HERE

Teardown, parts trading and certification paperwork are real MRO careers, not a sideline. Students should understand traceability, Form 1 / 8130-3 documentation and airworthiness release — that is what turns a removed part into a saleable one.

SOURCES

AviTrader, 27 Aug 2026 — [avitrader.com/2026/08/27/second-a320-acquisition-boosts-werner-aeros-parts-drive/](https://www.avitrader.com/2026/08/27/second-a320-acquisition-boosts-werner-aeros-parts-drive/)
Aviation Week, MRO Rolling Daily Updates, 27–28 Aug 2026 — aviationweek.com/mro/mro-industry-rolling-daily-updates-august-2026

02 TECHNICAL & REGULATORY

FAA Orders Repeat Wing Inspections on Boeing 787s

The FAA published Airworthiness Directive 2026-17-02 in the Federal Register on 27 August 2026, effective 1 October 2026. It applies to Boeing 787-8, 787-9 and 787-10 aircraft.

The unsafe condition traces back to build quality: shim gaps may have exceeded engineering allowances, and high pull-up forces used to close those gaps could start fatigue cracks at fastener holes. A **shim** is a thin filler placed between two structural parts so they mate without being forced together.

Operators must carry out repetitive ultrasonic (UT) and detailed visual (DET) inspections of the lower side-of-body splice plates, rear and front spar terminal fittings, lower chords and jack pads — and repair anything found. The FAA counts 17 US-registered aircraft affected, with cost estimated at up to \$24,310 per aircraft per inspection cycle.

An **Airworthiness Directive** is not advice. It is a legally binding instruction; ignoring it makes the aircraft unairworthy.

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US-registered Boeing 787s covered by the new directive

WHY IT MATTERS HERE

This directive touches three things on our syllabus at once: non-destructive testing, primary structure and fatigue, and human factors in assembly. A manufacturing decision can become a maintenance task for the next twenty years.

SOURCE

Federal Register, 27 Aug 2026 — AD 2026-17-02, Docket FAA-2026-2295 — [federalregister.gov/documents/2026/08/27/2026-17553/airworthiness-directives-the-boeing-company-airplanes](https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/08/27/2026-17553/airworthiness-directives-the-boeing-company-airplanes)

03 CAREERS & LICENSING

Watchdog Asks FAA to Widen Mechanic Exam Access

The US Government Accountability Office has recommended that the FAA formally examine letting students at non-certificated institutions sit the general written knowledge test for the Airframe & Powerplant (A&P) certificate. The recommendation was reported on 1 September 2026. At present that route is generally open to graduates of FAA-certificated maintenance schools, or to applicants who can document the required practical experience.

It lands against a clear demand picture. Aviation Week reported on 27 August that the Asia-Pacific region alone will need more than 300,000 new maintenance technicians over the next decade, citing Boeing's forecast that the region will account for over 40% of the world's new technicians through 2045. In the same week HAECO said a planned joint venture in Vietnam would create more than 1,000 jobs.

The debate is essentially about how many doors lead to a licence, and how quickly.

300,000+

New maintenance technicians Asia-Pacific needs over the next decade

WHY IT MATTERS HERE

Licensing pathways decide careers. Whichever system you train under — FAA A&P, EASA Part-66, or a GCAA CAR-66 licence — the modules, exams and logged experience are the currency. Watch these rule changes: they change how portable your qualification is.

SOURCES

Aviation Week, 1 Sep 2026 — aviationweek.com/mro/workforce-training/gao-faa-should-consider-expanding-ap-test-eligibility
Aviation Week, 27 Aug 2026 — aviationweek.com/mro/workforce-training/asia-pacific-mros-face-labor-hurdles-demand-accelerates

ALSO SEEN THIS WEEK

- Turkish Technic** opened a seventh Istanbul hangar (29,400 m²), lifting single-city capacity to 57 aircraft — first reported 23 August, just outside this week's window.
- Willis Lease Finance** bought land in Johor, Malaysia for a new engine repair centre targeted for Q1 2027 (1 September).
- Batam Aero Technic** gained South Korean MRO approval (26 August) — cross-border regulatory recognition in practice.
- No major **Gulf-specific** MRO announcement landed inside the window; flydubai's Dubai South maintenance centre is still due to complete in Q4 2026.

JARGON CHECK

MRO Maintenance, Repair & Overhaul.	AD Airworthiness Directive — a mandatory regulator instruction.
USM Used serviceable material — parts recovered from a retired aircraft and re-certified.	NDT / UT Non-destructive testing; ultrasonic inspection is one method.
A&P Airframe & Powerplant — the US mechanic certificate.	Part-66 / CAR-66 EASA and UAE GCAA licence frameworks for engineers.